

Homewise VOC Interview Notes #2

Before the interview (screener)

Have you hired a contractor before?

Yes — hired a plumber for a clogged kitchen sink.

Roughly what did the project cost?

~\$380–\$400 for ~30 minutes of work.

Do you own your home?

No — renter.

Warm-up

Tell me a bit about your home — how long have you owned it, and how often do you hire contractors?

Renter. Uses kitchen daily; does not frequently hire contractors. Tried DIY first before hiring due to cost concerns.

The Recent Experience

1. Walk me through the last time you hired a contractor.

Kitchen sink stopped draining. Tried DIY fixes (vinegar, Drano) for 2–3 days without success. Decided to hire a plumber due to urgency.

2. How did you find them? What sources did you use?

Used Yelp. Looked at highest-rated options.

3. How did you decide which ones to contact? What made you rule some out?

Noticed even high-rated companies had negative reviews (overcharging, no-shows). Ultimately chose the **first one who answered the phone** due to urgency.

4. How many quotes did you get? How did you compare them?

Only one quote. No comparison

5. How did you know if the price was fair?

Did not know. Felt afterward that the price was too high and not worth it.

6. What did you do to check if they were licensed, insured, or reputable?

Relied on Yelp ratings only. No additional verification.

7. Walk me through scheduling and the actual work.

- Called and described issue
- Agreed on time
- Plumber arrived on time
- Gave upfront quote (\$400 → negotiated to \$380)
- Work completed very quickly using a pressure machine (no disassembly)

8. After the work was done, what happened with paperwork, receipts, warranties?

N/A

Pain Point

What was the most frustrating part?

Finding a contractor (searching and deciding who to trust).

If you could change one thing, what would it be?

- Contacts multiple contractors
- Collects ~5 quotes

Current Workarounds & Prior Spending

Do you do anything today to make hiring easier?

No structured system. Just searches Yelp and calls manually.

Have you paid for a service like Angi or Thumbtack?

No

Wrap-up

Describe the experience in a few words:

- Urgent
- Expensive
- Inefficient
- Frustrating (especially discovery phase)